

The Cut — Step by Step

The complete professional haircutting service, and the experience that turns a trim into an Amber service

Learning Objectives

- Perform the complete Amber haircutting protocol from consultation through finish
- Explain elevation and its effect on the shape a cut produces
- Distinguish blunt cutting, point cutting, and texturising, and when to use each
- Check a finished cut for balance and symmetry before releasing a client from the chair

A trim, or an experience

Two stylists can perform the technically identical cut and leave a client with entirely different feelings about the appointment. The difference is rarely the scissors. It is whether the service felt considered, unhurried, and complete — from the moment the client sat down to the moment she checked the back of her head in a hand mirror before leaving. This module is the full choreography.

Step 1 · Recap and confirm

Before a single section is clipped, revisit the consultation from Module Ten aloud: confirm the agreed length, shape, and any texturising, and show the client roughly where the new length will fall using your fingers against dry, unstyled hair. A cut should never be a surprise reveal — the client should already know, in general terms, what she is about to see.

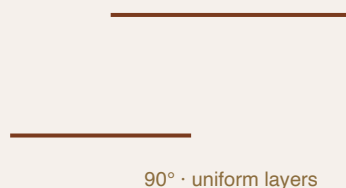
Step 2 · Wash and prep

Cut on clean hair, free of product buildup that can disguise true texture and weight. Detangle gently from ends upward, per Module Six, before any sectioning begins — cutting through knotted, tangled hair produces uneven results and unnecessary breakage.

Step 3 · Section with intention

Using the four- or nine-section pattern from Module Nine, divide the hair into clean, even partings. Work section by section, never freehanding across the whole head at once — precision comes from control, and control comes from discipline in the sectioning.

◆ Figure 11.1 · Elevation and Shape



The angle hair is lifted from the head determines the final shape — low elevation preserves weight, high elevation builds layers.

Step 4 · Understand elevation

Elevation is the angle at which a section is lifted away from the head before cutting, and it is the single biggest determinant of the shape a haircut produces.

- **0° elevation (no lift)** — hair is cut against the head with no lift, producing a blunt, weight-heavy line. Used for one-length bobs and blunt ends.
- **45° elevation** — a moderate lift, producing graduation — a gentle build of layers that adds movement without removing all the weight.
- **90° elevation** — hair is lifted straight out from the head, producing uniform layers of consistent length throughout.

Step 5 · Choose the cutting technique

- **Blunt cutting** — a straight, horizontal cut across the section, producing a strong, defined line and maximum weight retention.
- **Point cutting** — the shears held vertically into the ends, softening a blunt line without removing significant length.

- **Texturising (slide or notch cutting)** — selectively removing bulk within the length of the hair, used to reduce weight in dense hair or add movement to fine hair without shortening it overall.

Step 6 · Check for balance

Before styling begins, cross-check the cut dry and wet: compare both sides of the head with the client's chin level and shoulders square, check the perimeter line from the back with a hand mirror shown to the client, and confirm layers fall evenly when the hair is shaken loose. Small asymmetries are corrected now, never discovered by the client at home in better lighting.

Step 7 · Style and send off

Finish with a blow-dry or styling appropriate to the client's texture (Module Twelve expands this fully), using the heat protocol from Module Seven without exception. Close the appointment with brief, written aftercare guidance — when to trim next, and one or two product recommendations suited to what you observed during the service.

Key Terms

0

[object Object]

1

[object Object]

2

[object Object]

Practical Activity · The Full Protocol

Perform a complete haircutting service on a partner or mannequin head, narrating each of the seven steps aloud as you perform it. Have an observer note anything skipped or rushed. **Photograph the finished result from front, back, and both sides — this becomes part of your capstone portfolio.**